

tion instruction sets that need to be enabled in the BIOS, if it already isn't. This will help with a smoother experience.

17 Windows Timeline

Hitting **[Windows] + [Tab]** on Windows 10 brings up your timeline that shows your activities across supported apps in the past. Windows also groups supported apps together around the same time. For instance, if you bring up a presentation that you were working on last week, you also get the option to bring up the related browser tabs that were open. While limited apps are supported, Microsoft is working with devs to change that.

18 Cloud Copy Paste

Windows 10 allows you to have a clipboard in the cloud with the cloud clipboard feature. Go to **Start > Settings > System > Clipboard** and enable **Sync across devices**. This lets you copy on one device and paste on another, and also lets you save multiple items to your cloud clipboard

19 Old Volume Control bar

The old version of the volume control bar is still available in Windows 10, and if you are more comfortable with it, you can get it back. Open up regedit,



go to **HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows NT\CurrentVersion**, create new key called **MTCUVC**, new DWORD called **EnableMtcUvc**, and set the value to zero.

20 Per app GPU management

While similar tweaks are available with dedicated GPU management software from graphics card manufacturers, you can use an inbuilt feature of Windows to set per app GPU performance. Go to **Settings > Dis-**

play > Graphics settings and then choose an app to set preferences for.

21 Kill Cortana

Once the Registry Editor is open, navigate to the following folder in the left-hand navigation pane: **HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE > Software > Policies > Microsoft > Windows > Windows Search**.

If the Windows Search folder isn't there, right-click the Windows folder, select **New > Key**, and name it **Windows Search**.

With the Windows Search folder selected in the left-hand navigation pane, right-click in the main portion of the window and select **New > DWORD (32-bit) Value**. A new listing will appear in the main pane, ready to be named; christen it **AllowCortana**. Next, double-click it and in the box that appears, ensure that the **Value Data** is set to **'0'** – minus the quotation marks, of course.

22 Disable background apps

Windows 10 allows you to enable or disable background apps from running after system start-up. By default, all the apps will run in the background. If you think that you don't want some apps to run in the background then you can simply turn it off. Head over to **Settings > Privacy > Background apps** or simply search for **"Background apps"** from the Windows Start Search bar. Here, all the apps will be listed. Disabling them will disallow them from receiving info, sending notifications and updating automatically. Although it won't be a problem for desktop PCs, if you wish to save some battery on your laptop, disabling them will surely give you some extra juice.

23 Disable lockscreen

Unless you're using a password to protect your desktop or laptop, you don't really need a lockscreen. It introduces an extra step when you start up your system or when you've left your system idle for a long time. To disable the lockscreen, open up the Run window by pressing **[Windows] + [R]**. Enter **"gpedit.msc"** in the text area of the Run window without quotes that will open the **Local Group Policy Editor**. Navigate through **Computer Configuration > Administrative Templates > Control Panel > Person-**

alization and then on the right, you will find the **"Do not display the lockscreen"** option. Double click on it to open its settings and select **Enabled**. This will disable the lockscreen and it will take effect after a system restart.

24 Easy snipping tool

An interesting update introduced to Windows 10 is a revamp of the Snipping Tool. Earlier, you had to open the software manually and then take the required screenshot. With the new update, all you need to do is press **[Windows] + [Shift] + [S]** that opens an overlay of the Snipping Tool. You can either take a screenshot of the entire desktop, rectangular area or any random shaped area using your mouse pointer. Once you've taken the screenshot, a notification pops up about your screenshot being saved. If you wish to make changes such as annotations, you can press on the notification to open the Screen Sketch app. Here, you can add text, annotate and do much more.

25 Battery usage by apps

Desktop owners don't need to worry about this tip. However, if you use a laptop then you might be interested in checking which apps are using or straight up draining your battery. In order to find out, head over to **Settings > Battery**. You'll find the **"See which apps are affecting your battery life"** button right below the battery percentage. By clicking that button, you'll be taken to a list of all the apps running on your system and the amount of battery they are using at three different time intervals including six hours, one day and one week. If you find a rogue application eating away too much battery, you should probably reinstall or simply uninstall it.

26 Run the Bash shell

If you weren't aware, Windows now allows you to run the Linux Bash shell after the Anniversary update. However, this option isn't enabled by default and you'll